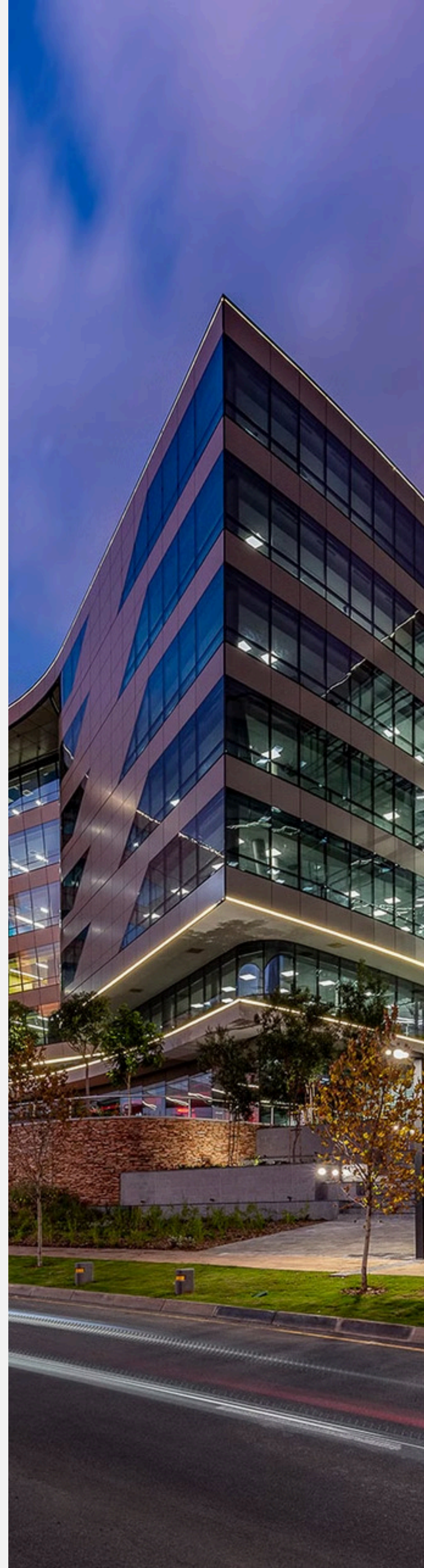


**Step by Step Guide -
Training Manual
Standard Operating
Procedure**



Introduction to this Training Manual

Purpose of This Training Manual

The Visa Adjudication System (VAS) Training Manual is designed to provide a step-by-step guide for immigration officers and adjudicators responsible for processing visa applications within the Department of Home Affairs. This manual ensures that users understand the standard operating procedures (SOPs) required to review, verify, and finalize visa applications in compliance with South African immigration laws and policies.

By following this guide, adjudicators will be able to:

- Navigate the Visa Adjudication System (VAS) efficiently.
- Review and verify applicant information and supporting documents.
- Make informed decisions on visa approvals or rejections.
- Ensure compliance with immigration regulations and internal protocols.

Scope and Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

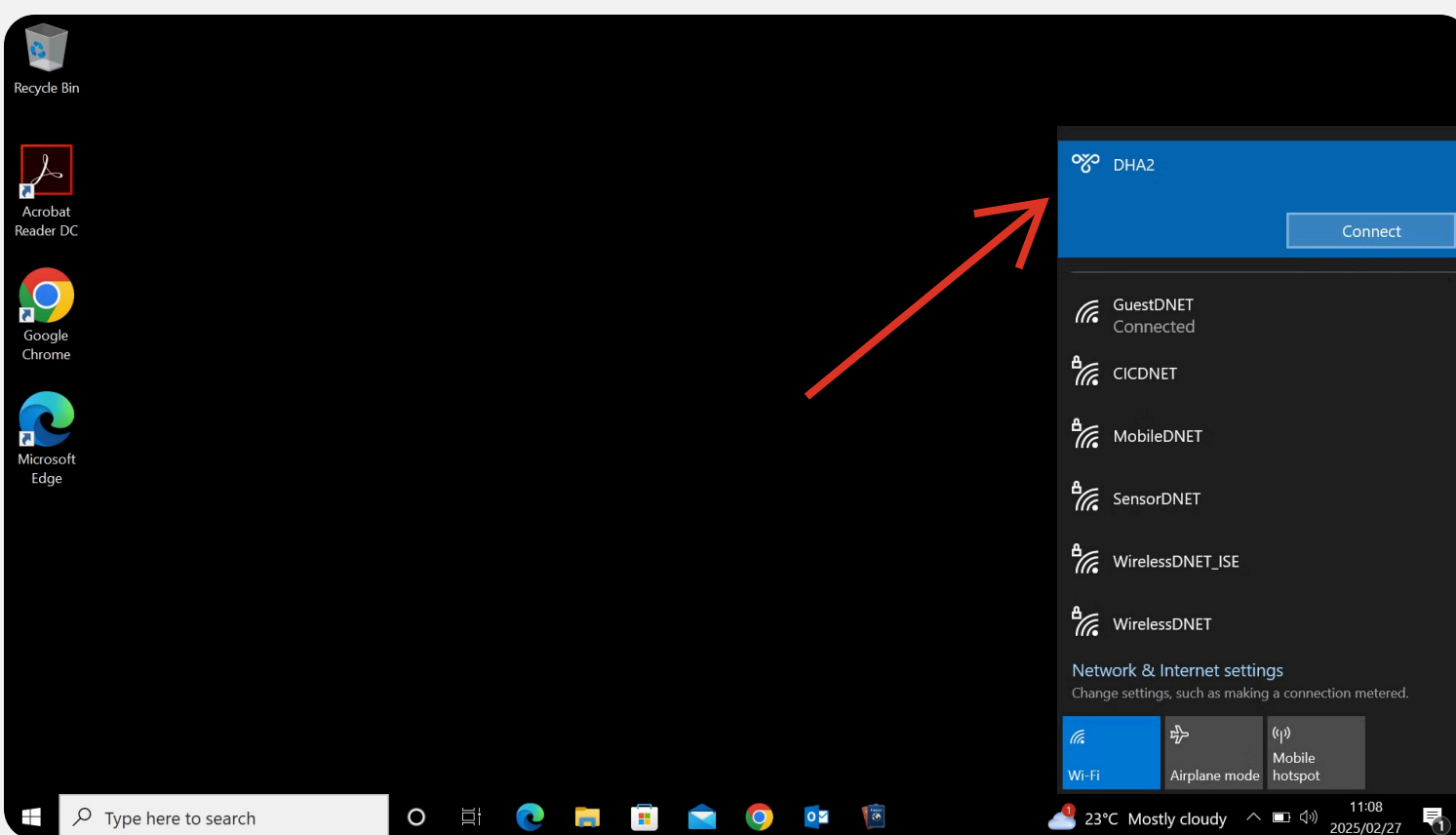
The standard operating procedure (SOP) outlined in this manual ensures consistency, accuracy, and fairness in the adjudication process. The key SOP steps include:

1. System Access and Login • Connecting to the DHA2 WiFi • Logging into the Visa Adjudication System (VAS)
2. Application Review and Verification • Selecting the appropriate visa category • Reviewing applicant details and verifying required documents
3. Decision-Making Process • Assessing eligibility based on documentation and compliance • Selecting the appropriate visa validity period and conditions
4. Finalizing the Application • Making an approval or rejection decision • Submitting the finalized application and updating the system records

This manual is intended for official use and must be adhered to in order to maintain transparency, consistency, and regulatory compliance in all visa adjudication procedures.

Select the DHA Network

- **Step 1: Open the WiFi Network List**
 - Click on the WiFi icon in the bottom-right corner of the taskbar.
 - This will open the list of available WiFi networks.
- **Step 2: Select the DHA2 Network**
 - Scroll through the list and locate DHA2.
 - Click on DHA2 to expand the connection options.
- **Step 3: Connect to the Network**
 - Click the “Connect” button.
 - If prompted, enter the WiFi password (provided by your IT department or administrator).
 - Press Enter or click Next to proceed.



Logging into the DHA2 WiFi using an email and password

- **Step 1: Enter Your Credentials**

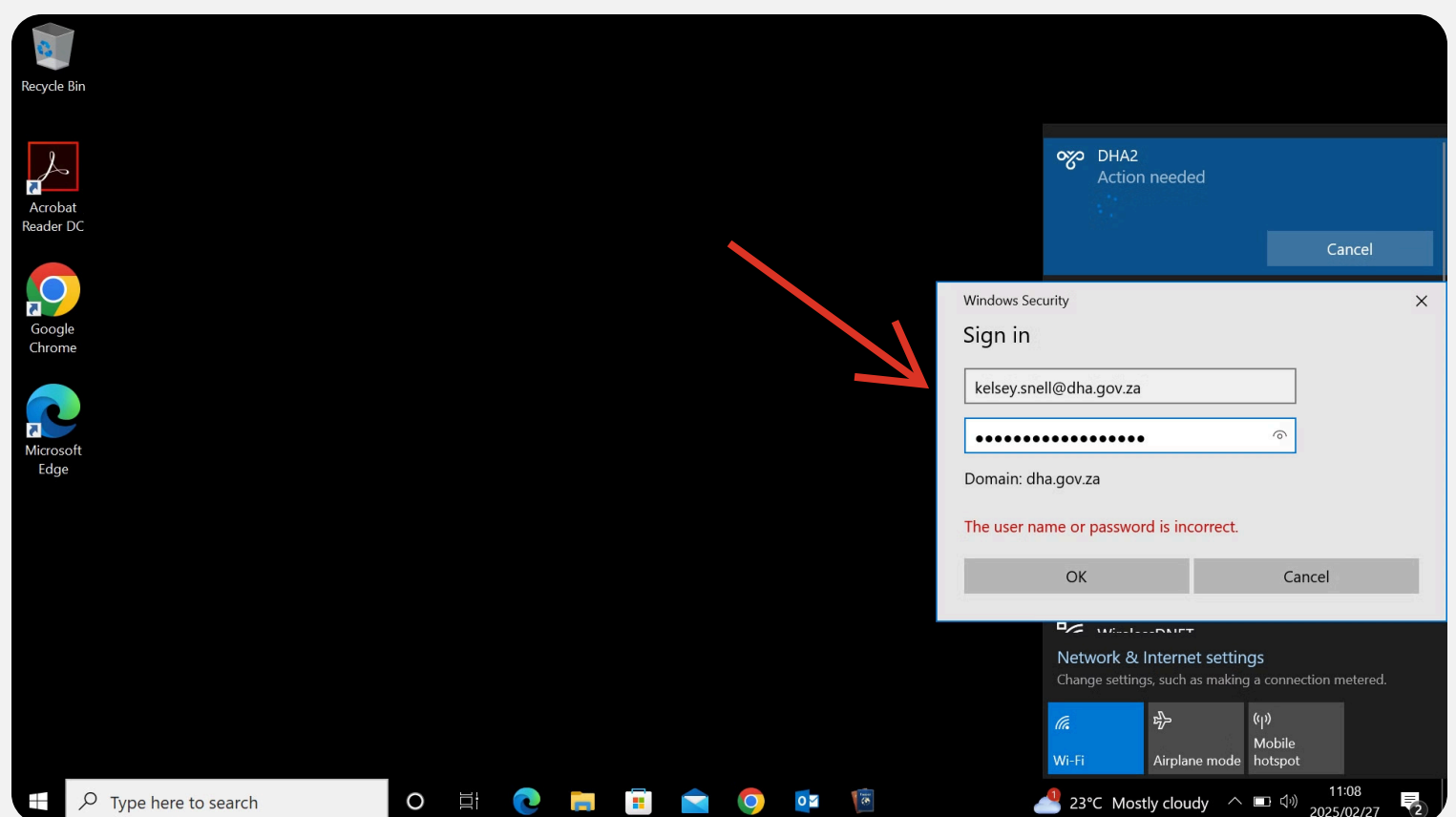
- Once you select the DHA2 network and click “Connect”, a Windows Security sign-in prompt will appear.
- In the Username field, enter your email address (e.g., kelsey.snell@dha.gov.za).
- In the Password field, type your 12-character alphanumeric password carefully.

- **Step 2: Attempt to Sign In**

- Click the “OK” button to proceed.

- **Step 3: Troubleshooting Login Issues**

- If you see the error message “The user name or password is incorrect”:
- Re-enter your credentials carefully and try again.
- If you forgot your password, contact your IT support for a reset.
- Ensure you have a stable internet connection before attempting again.



Verifying that the DHA2 WiFi is connected

- **Step 1: Confirm Connection Status**

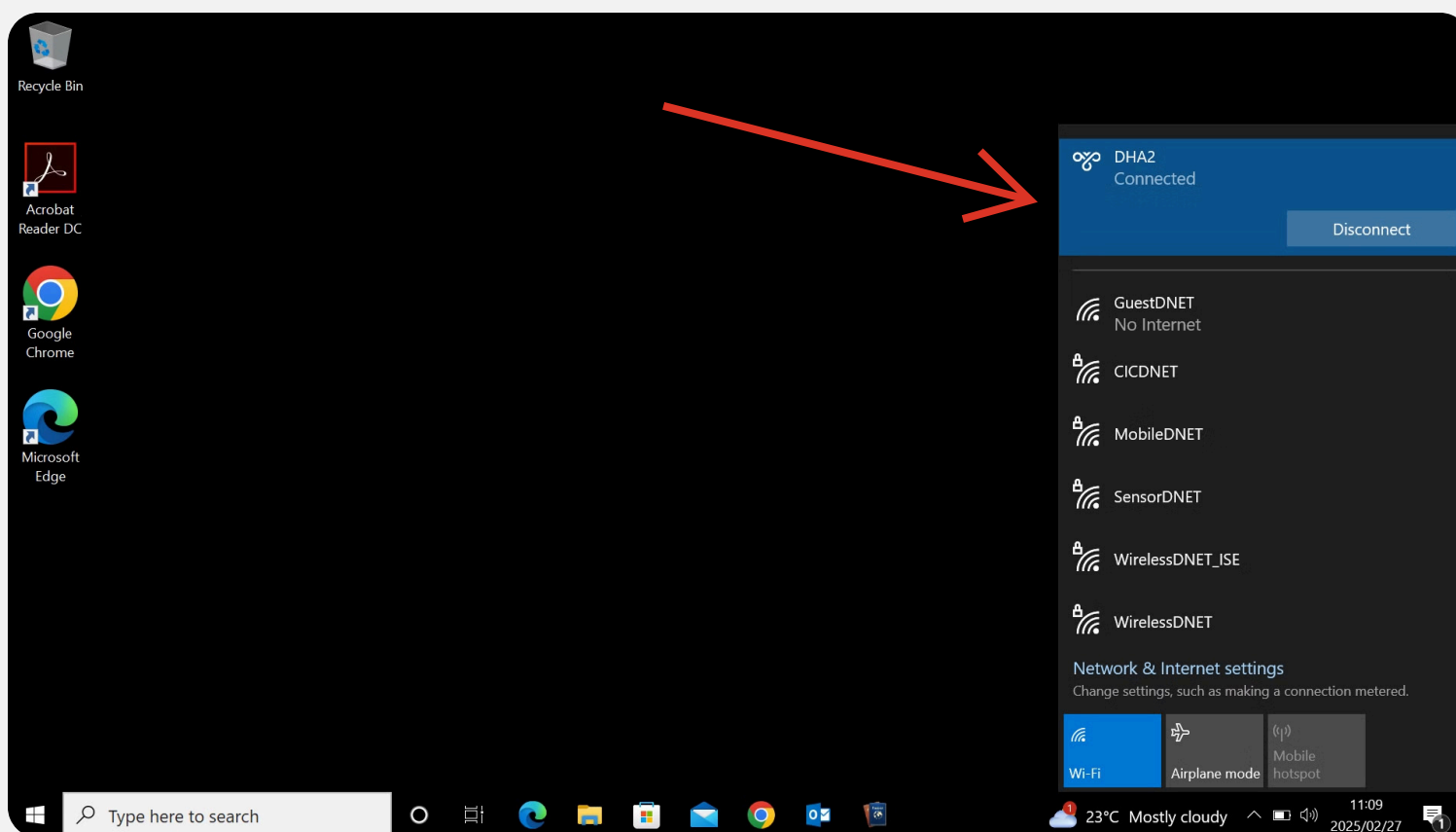
- After entering your credentials and successfully logging in, the WiFi panel should update to show “DHA2 - Connected”.
- The “Connect” button will change to “Disconnect”, confirming an active connection.

- **Step 2: Verify Network Access**

- Click the WiFi icon in the bottom-right corner of the taskbar to open the network list
- Ensure DHA2 is listed as “Connected”.

- **Step 3: Troubleshooting if Connection Fails**

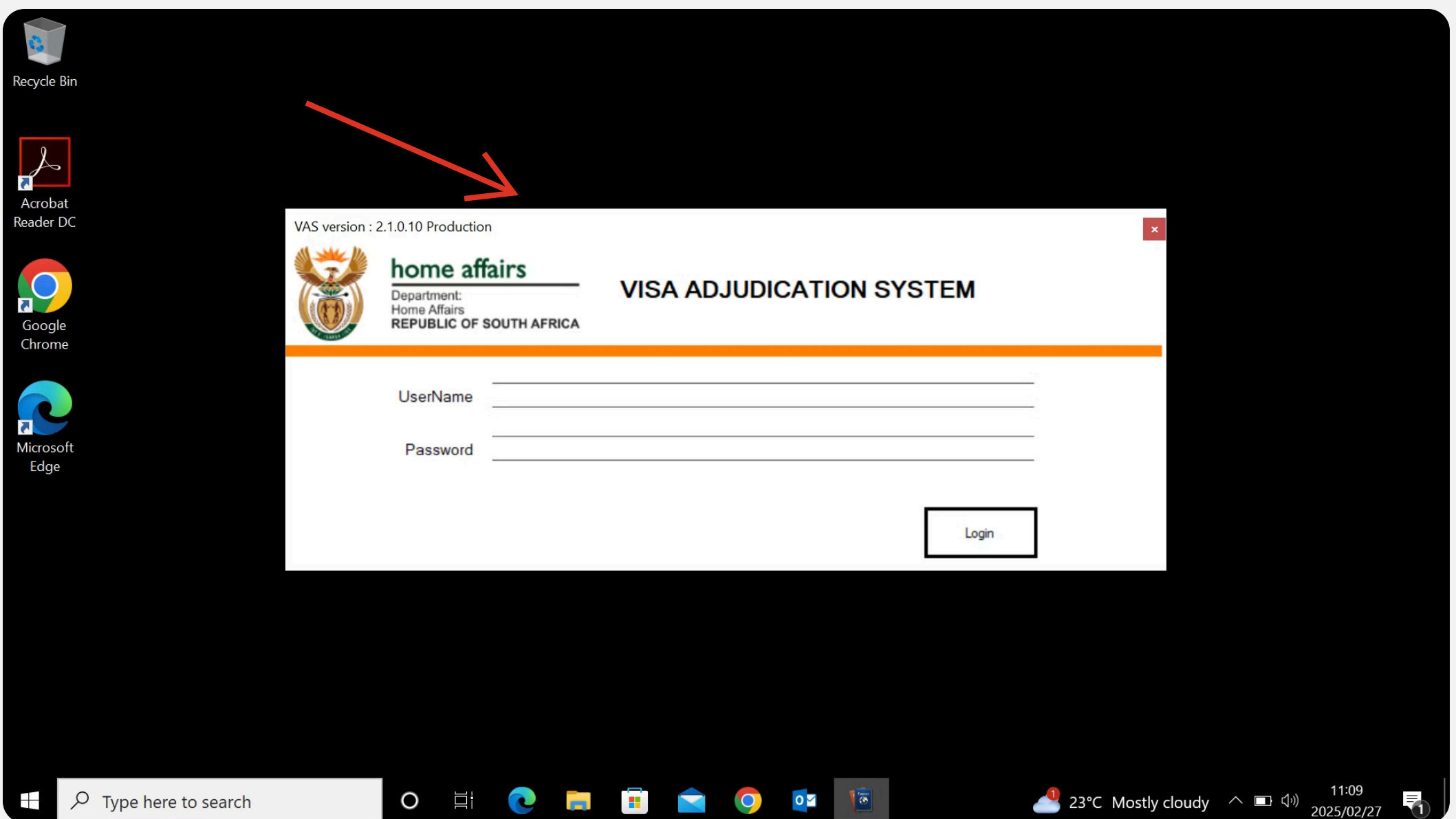
- If it shows “Connected, No Internet”, try:
- Restarting your device and reconnecting.
- Disconnecting and reconnecting manually.
- Checking with IT support if the issue persists.



Logging into the Visa Adjudication System

- **Step 1: Open the Visa Adjudication System**

- Once connected to the DHA2 WiFi, the Visa Adjudication System (VAS) login screen should appear automatically.



Entering your credentials in the Visa Adjudication System

- **Step 1: Enter Your Credentials**

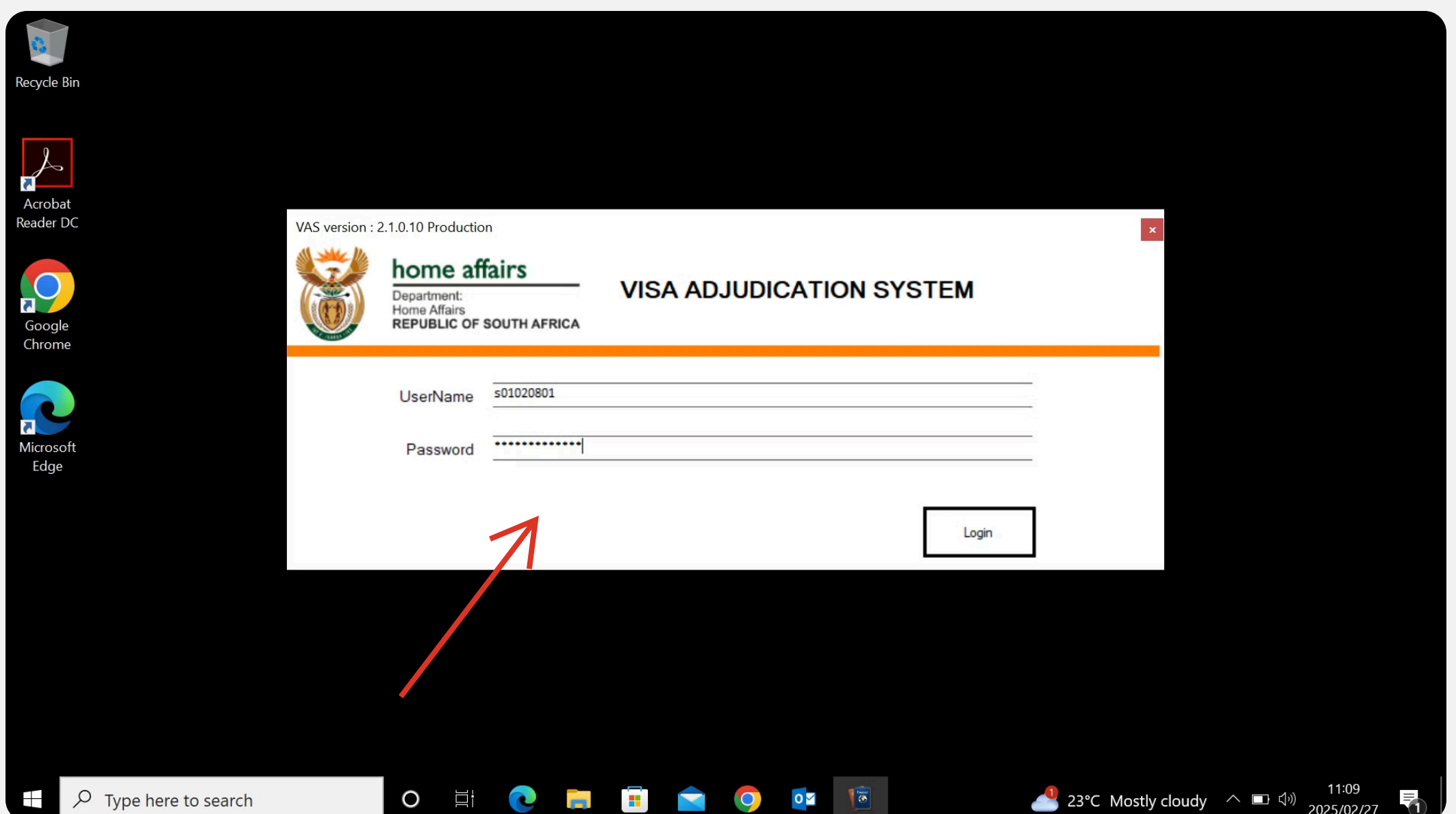
- In the Username field, type your official VAS username (use your **S** number).
- In the Password field, enter your assigned VAS password.

- **Step 2: Sign In**

- Click the “Login” button to proceed.
- Wait for the system to authenticate your credentials.

- **Step 3: Troubleshooting Login Issues (Optional)**

- If your login fails, ensure:
- You are using the correct username and password.
- Your WiFi connection is active.
- Your account is not locked (contact IT support if necessary).



Confirming that the Visa Adjudication System (VAS) has successfully opened

- **Step 1: Verify Successful Login**

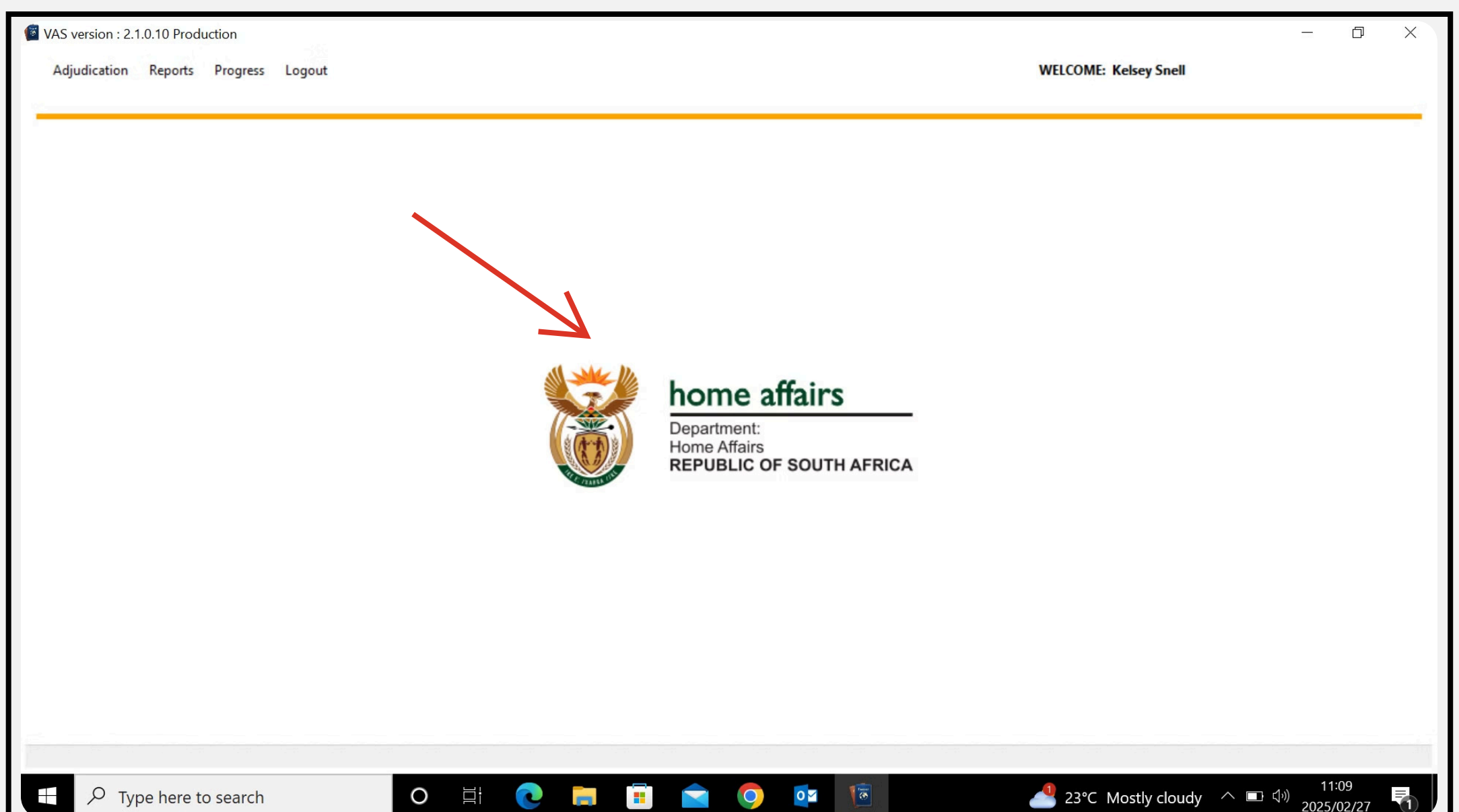
- After entering your credentials and clicking “Login”, the system should authenticate your details.
- If your credentials were correct, you will be redirected to the Visa Adjudication System (VAS) homepage.

- **Step 2: Confirm System Access**

- The Home Affairs logo and the text “Department of Home Affairs - Republic of South Africa” should be displayed prominently.
- Your name should appear in the top-right corner (e.g., “WELCOME: Kelsey Snell”), confirming that you are logged in under your user account.

- **Step 3: Familiarize Yourself with the Menu (Optional)**

- The top navigation menu contains several options, including:
- Adjudication – Access adjudication-related tasks.
- Reports – View and generate system reports.
- Progress – Check case progress.
- Logout – Securely exit the system.



Accessing the Adjudication tab in the Visa Adjudication System (VAS)

- **Step 1: Locate the Adjudication Tab**

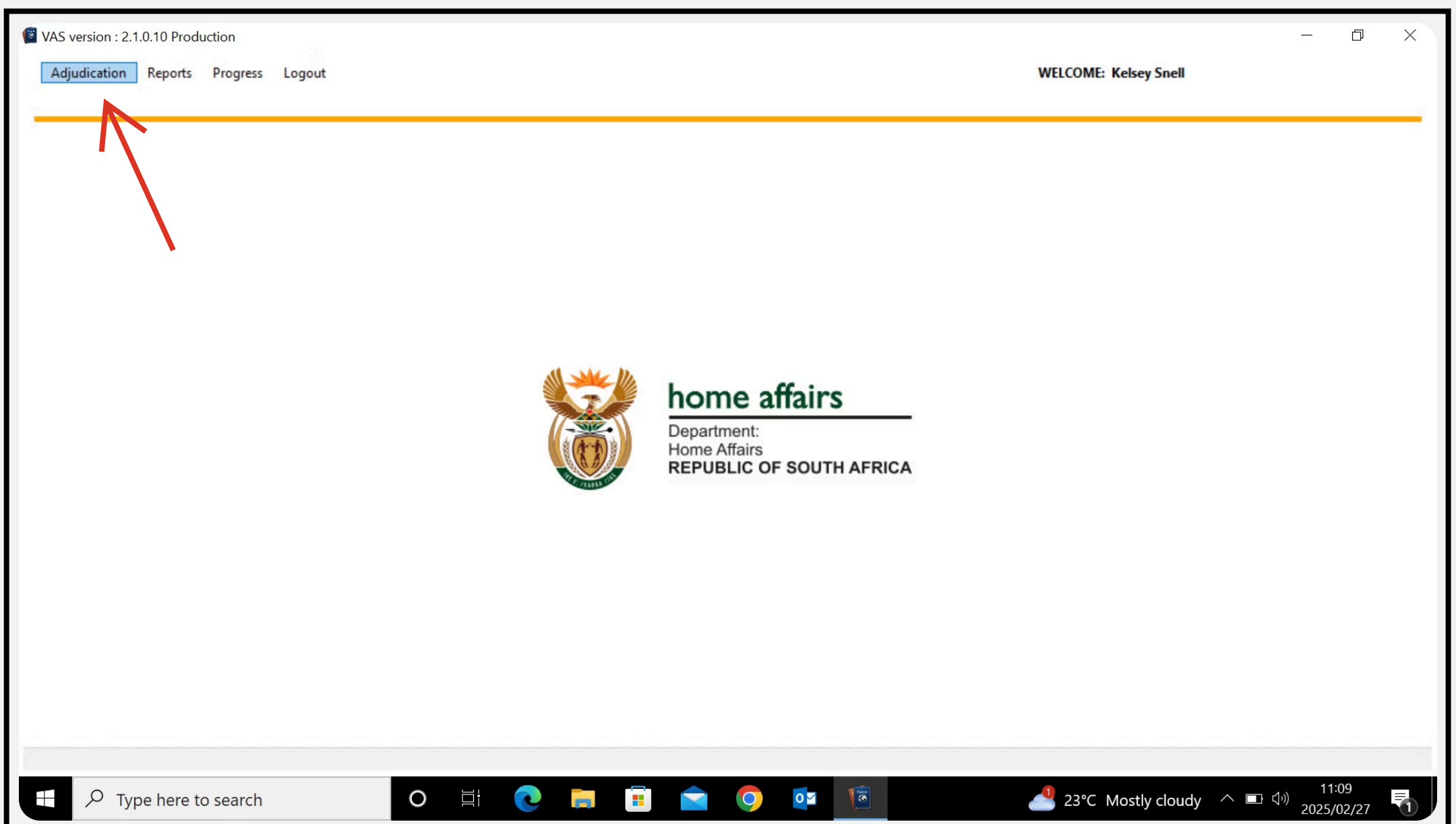
- Once the Visa Adjudication System (VAS) homepage loads, locate the navigation menu at the top of the screen.

- **Step 2: Click on 'Adjudication'**

- Click on the "Adjudication" tab.
- This tab is highlighted in blue once selected, indicating it is active.
- Wait for the system to load the adjudication interface.

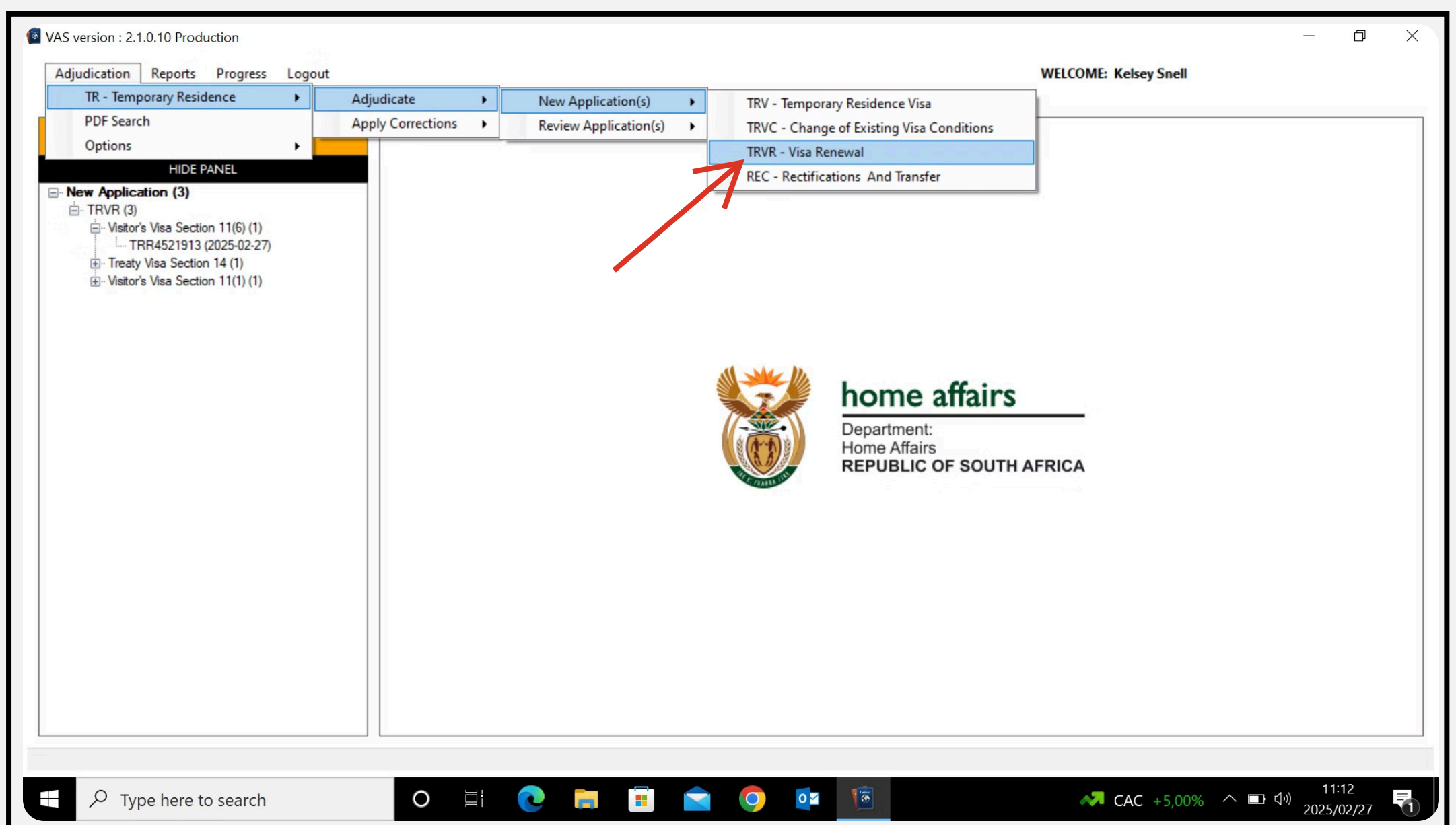
- **Step 3: Proceed to the Next Steps**

- Once the Adjudication screen loads, you will be able to access and process visa applications.



Selecting the visa category for adjudication

- **Step 1: Navigate to the Visa Adjudication Menu**
 - After clicking on “Adjudication”, a drop-down menu appears with multiple options.
 - Hover over “TR - Temporary Residence” to expand further options.
- **Step 2: Select the Visa Application Type**
 - Under “Adjudicate”, hover over “New Application(s)” or “Review Application(s)”, depending on your task.
 - You will see different visa categories such as: • TRV - Temporary Residence Visa • TRVC - Change of Existing Visa Conditions • TRVR - Visa Renewal • REC - Rectifications and Transfers
- **Step 3: Click on the Relevant Visa Category**
 - Click on the visa category that corresponds to the application you need to process.
 - In this example below, “TRVR - Visa Renewal” is highlighted.
- **Step 4: Proceed to Adjudicate**
 - You can now proceed with adjudication based on the case details.



Selecting an application for adjudication

- **Step 1: Open the Adjudication Inbox**

- After selecting the visa category (e.g., TRVR - Visa Renewal), the TRVR Adjudication Inbox will appear.
- The left panel displays a list of New Applications that require processing.

- **Step 2: Locate the Application**

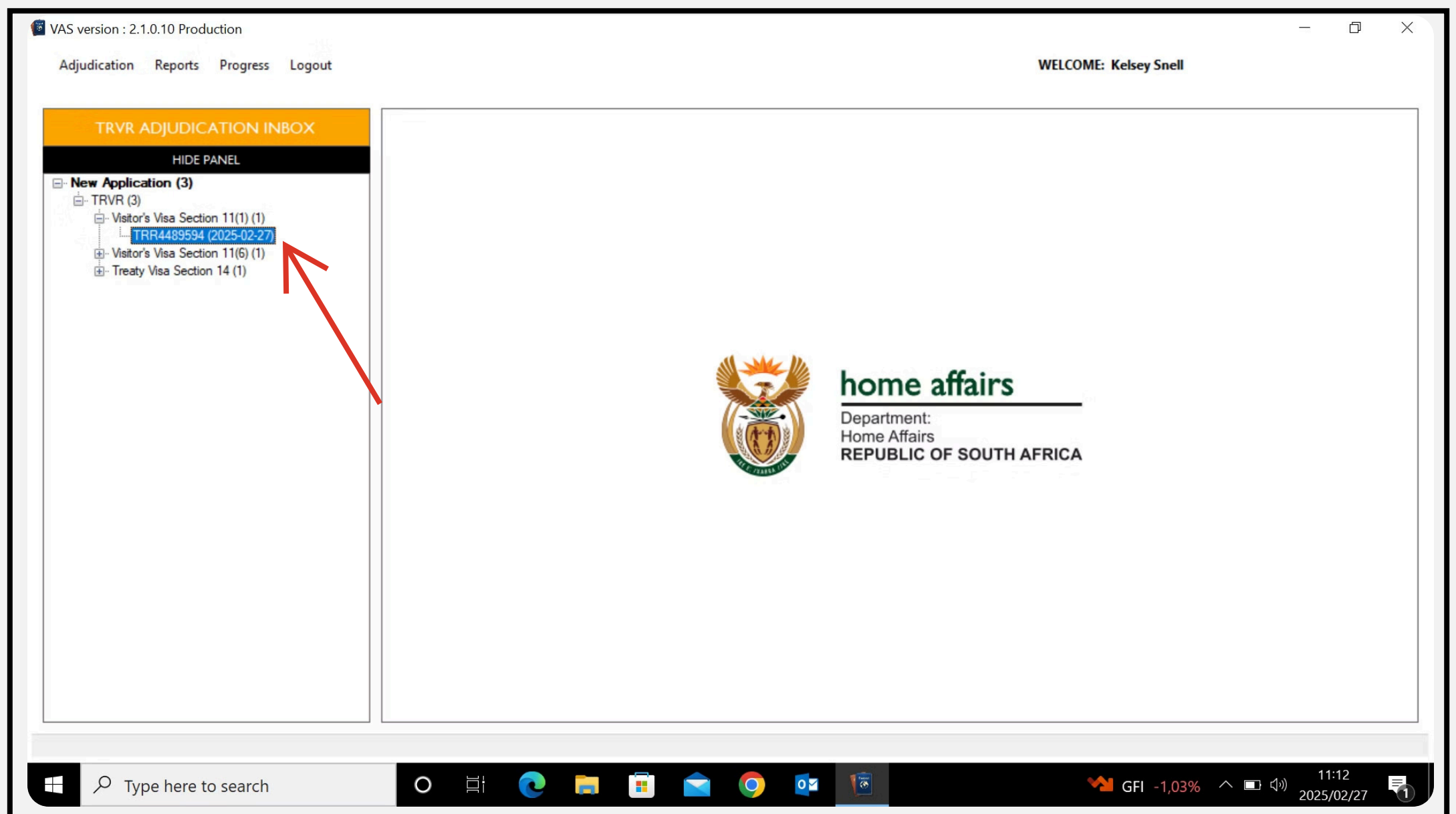
- Expand the TRVR section by clicking on the "+" sign (if not already expanded).

- **Step 3: Click on the Application Number**

- Click on the specific application number you need to adjudicate.
- In this example, the selected application is TRR4489594 (2025-02-27).
- Once selected, the system will load the application details.

- **Step 4: Proceed to Review the Application**

- The system will now display the application form and any relevant supporting documents.



Adjudicating an applicant's visa application

- **Step 1: Review Applicant Information**
 - Once the application loads, the applicant's electronic details will be displayed at the top.
 - Confirm details such as: • Tracking Number • First Name and Last Name • Date of Birth • Gender and Country of Birth • Passport Number and Expiry Date • Passport Country of Issue
 - Carefully check for any discrepancies in the applicant's information.
- **Step 2: Review the Application Form**
 - Scroll down to view the application form.
 - Ensure the correct visa renewal type is selected.
 - Verify supporting information against the provided documents.

VAS version : 2.1.0.10 Production

Adjudication Reports Progress Logout

WELCOME: Kelsey Snell

TRVR ADJUDICATION INBOX

HIDE PANEL

New Application (3)

- TRVR (3)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(1) (1)
 - TRR4489594 (2025-02-27)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(6) (1)
 - Treaty Visa Section 14 (1)

TRACKING NUMBER :: TRR4489594

Application Details Verify Required Documents Office Notes Attach Referrals Referral Attachments Park Reason(s)

+ HIDE These details will be used when preparing the outcome of this application

Applicant Electronic Details

Active Applicant Details TRVR Applicant Details

TrackingNo	First Name	Last Name	Date Of Birth	Maiden Name	Gender	Country Of Birth	Passport Number	Passport Expiry Date	Passport Country Of Iss
TRR4489594	SONIA	MIRIAN THE KELLY	1946-09-15		Unknown	Cyprus	L00298369	2034-03-15	Cyprus

Recommendation : Mark application for error correction, to update the active applicant's details

☐ Mark Application For Correction Status None

Application Form

DEPARTMENT OF HOME AFFAIRS
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA
APPLICATION FOR RENEWAL OF EXISTING VISA
[Section 10(7), Regulation 9(9)]

For official use only	Track and Trace Ref No.	BLOK:
Office of application	File No.	

Denis <Please select decision> Save

Type here to search

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11:13
2025/02/27

Verifying documents in the Visa Adjudication System

- **Step 1: Open the 'Verify Required Documents' Tab**

- After selecting and opening the applicant's visa application, navigate to the "Verify Required Documents" tab.
- The system will display a list of required documents needed for visa adjudication.

- **Step 2: Check Each Document**

- Carefully review each document listed in the “Document Name” column.
- Documents may include: • Duly completed online form (Handwritten forms are not accepted) • Valid passport (Must be valid for at least 30 days after intended departure) • Medical report (No older than 6 months at submission) • Proof of sufficient financial means • Return flight ticket or reservation proof

- **Step 3: Select Verified Documents**

- Tick the checkbox next to each document that has been successfully verified.

- **Step 4: Address Missing or Invalid Documents**

- If a document is missing or invalid: • Do not tick the corresponding checkbox.
- Use the remarks section to note the missing document.

VAS version : 2.1.0.10 Production
WELCOME: Kelsey Snell

Adjudication Reports Progress Logout

TRVR ADJUDICATION INBOX

HIDE PANEL

New Application (3)

- TRVR (3)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(1) (1)
 - TRR4489594 (2025-02-27)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(6) (1)
 - Treaty Visa Section 14 (1)

TRACKING NUMBER :: TRR4489594

Application Details
Verify Required Documents
Office Notes
Attach Referrals
Referral Attachments
Park Reason(s)

Select	Document Name
1	☒ Duly completed online form. Handwritten forms will not be accepted by Department of Home Affairs
2	☒ Valid passport which expires in no less than 30 days after expiry of the intended date of departure from the Republic
3	☒ A medical report not older than 6 months at the time of submission
4	☐ A yellow fever vaccination certificate if that person travelled or intends travelling from or transiting through a yellow fever endemic area: (Provided that the certificate shall not be require
5	☒ Police clearance certificate issued by the police or security authority in each country where the relevant applicant resided for 12 months or longer after attaining the age of 18 years, in r
6	☒ A radiological report. Provided that a radiological report shall not be required in respect of children under the age of 12 years or pregnant women

Verified Documents :

Duly completed online form. Handwritten forms will not be accepted by Department of Home Affairs

Valid passport which expires in no less than 30 days after expiry of the intended date of departure from the Republic

A medical report not older than 6 months at the time of submission

Police clearance certificate issued by the police or security authority in each country where the relevant applicant resided for 12 months or longer after attaining the age of 18 years, in respect of criminal records or the character of that applicant, which certifi

A radiological report. Provided that a radiological report shall not be required in respect of children under the age of 12 years or pregnant women

Proof of payment of the applicable fee

The application is being submitted in person, no less than 60 days prior to the expiry date of the applicant's visa and if the visa was issued for less than 30 days, not later than seven working days before the expiry of the visa

A statement or documentation detailing the purpose and duration of the visit

Proof of sufficient financial means

A valid return air flight ticket or proof of reservation thereof

Denies <Please select decision>
Save

Selecting a decision (Approve or Reject) for the visa application

- **Step 1: Review the Application Details**
 - After verifying the applicant’s documents, scroll down to the Application Form section.
 - Confirm key details such as: • Type of Visa: (e.g., Visitor Visa Entry Stamp) • Issued At: (e.g., Cape Town Airport) • Date of Issue/Renewal • Date of Expiry • Required Until (if applicable) • Purpose of Visa (e.g., Continue Visiting Purposes)
- **Step 2: Open the Decision Dropdown Menu**
 - At the bottom of the page, locate the Decision dropdown menu.
 - Click the dropdown to see available options: • APPROVE – If all requirements are met and the visa renewal is valid. • REJECT – If the application does not meet requirements or has missing documents. • REFER – If further review or additional information is needed. • PARK – If the application needs to be put on hold for now.
- **Step 3: Select ‘Approve’ or ‘Reject’**
 - Based on the review: • Select “APPROVE” if the applicant meets all criteria. • Select “REJECT” if there are disqualifying factors.
- **Step 4: Save the Decision**
 - Click the “Save” button to finalize your selection.
 - The system will update the application status accordingly.

VAS version : 2.1.0.10 Production

Adjudication Reports Progress Logout

WELCOME: Kelsey Snell

TRVR ADJUDICATION INBOX

HIDE PANEL

New Application (3)

- TRVR (3)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(1) (1)
 - TRR4489594 (2025-02-27)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(6) (1)
 - Treaty Visa Section 14 (1)

TRACKING NUMBER :: TRR4489594

Application Details Verify Required Documents Office Notes Attach Referrals Referral Attachments Park Reason(s)

+ HIDE These details will be used when preparing the outcome of this application

Applicant Electronic Details

Active Applicant Details TRVR Applicant Details

	TrackingNo	First Name	Last Name	Date Of Birth	Maiden Name	Gender	Country Of Birth	Passport Number	Passport Expiry Date	Passport Country Of Iss
	TRR4489594	SONIA	MIRIANE KEENE	1946-09-15		Unknown	Cyprus	L00298369	2034-03-15	Cyprus

Recommendation : Mark application for error correction, to update the active applicant's details

☐ Mark Application For Correction Status

Application Form

THEREOF:

Type of Visa: Visitor Visa Entry Stamp

Issued At: Cape Town Airport

Date of issue/renewal: 24-11-2024

Date of expiry: 22-02-2025

A visa is required until: 03-04-2025

Purpose of visa: Continue Visiting Purposes

(state reason(s) for request)

Decision

Please select decision-

Please select decision-

APPROVE

REJECT

REFER

PARK

Save

Type here to search

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11:14

2025/02/27

Selecting 'Calendar' as the period for the visa expiry date

- **Step 1: Open the Conditions Panel**

- After approving the application, a “Conditions” window will appear.
- In this window, you need to set the permit validity details, including:
 - Permit Valid From Date – The date when the visa becomes valid.
 - Expiry Date – When the visa will expire.
 - Period Type – Defines how the expiry period is calculated.

- **Step 2: Select the Expiry Period Type**

- Locate the “Period” dropdown menu.
- Click the dropdown and choose from the available options: • Months • Days • Calendar
- Select “Calendar”, as this allows you to specify an exact expiry date.

- **Step 3: Save and Submit**

- After selecting “Calendar”, ensure that all other fields are correctly filled.
- Click “Submit” to save the selection.

VAS version : 2.1.0.10 Production

Adjudication Reports Progress Logout

WELCOME: Kelsey Snell

TRVR ADJUDICATION INBOX

HIDE PANEL

New Application (3)

- TRVR (3)
- Visitor's Visa Section 11(1) (1)
- TRR4489594 (2025-02-27)
- Visitor's Visa Section 11(6) (1)
- Treaty Visa Section 14 (1)

Application Details

Verify Required Documents

Conditions

Application Form

+ HIDE These details

Applicant Electronic Details

Active Applicant Details TRVR Applicant Details

TrackingNo	First Name
TRR4489594	SONIA M

Recommendation

Mark Application For Consideration

Application Form

THEREOF:

Type of Visa

Issued At:

Date of issue

Date of expiry

A visa is required

Purpose of visit

(state reason)

Permit Valid From

Permit Valid From Date: 27 February 2025

Expiry Date

Period : **Period for expiry date** Period Value: 0

Condition Available

Purpose of visit: **To continue visit**

Standard Conditions

To continue visit

Not allowed to change status within South Africa

Subject to Reg. 3(7)

Comments :

Maximum Characters : 60 Remaining Characters : 60

Submit

Passport Number	Passport Expiry Date	Passport Country Of Issuance
L00298369	2034-03-15	Cyprus

Country Stamp

Airport

Visiting Purposes

APPROVE

Save

Type here to search

GFI -1,03%

11:14

2025/02/27

Selecting the months for the visa validity period

- **Step 1: Ensure 'Calendar' is Selected**
 - In the Conditions window, confirm that the "Period" field is set to "Calendar".
 - The Permit Valid From Date should already be set (e.g., 27 February 2025).
- **Step 2: Open the Expiry Date Calendar**
 - Click the Expiry Date field to open the calendar selection tool.
 - A dropdown calendar will appear, allowing you to choose the month and year for the visa expiry.
- **Step 3: Select the Expiry Month**
 - Click on the month corresponding to the number of months you are granting for the applicant's visa. • For example: • If granting 3 months, select May 2025. • If granting 6 months, select August 2025. • If granting 12 months, select February 2026.
 - Once you have selected the month, confirm the exact expiry date if needed.
- **Step 4: Save and Proceed**
 - Click "Submit" to confirm the expiry date selection.
 - The system will update the visa validity period accordingly.

The screenshot displays the VAS (Visa Application System) interface, version 2.1.0.10 Production. The main window shows the 'Application Form' for a visa application. The 'Permit Valid From' date is set to 27 February 2025. The 'Expiry Date' field is open, showing a dropdown calendar for the year 2025. The calendar is currently displaying the month of February, and the user is selecting the month of May. A red arrow points to the 'May' button in the calendar. The 'Period' is set to 'Calendar' and the 'Period Value' is 27 February 2025. The 'Conditions' section shows 'Available Conditions' and 'Standard Conditions'. The 'Purpose of visit' is set to 'Please Select'. The 'Comments' section shows 'Maximum Characters : 60' and 'Remaining Characters : 60'. The 'Submit' button is visible at the bottom right of the form. The interface also includes a sidebar with 'New Application (3)' and a list of applications, and a top navigation bar with 'Adjudication', 'Reports', 'Progress', and 'Logout'.

TrackingNo	First Name	Passport Number	Passport Expiry Date	Passport Country Of Iss
TRR4489594	SOMIA	0298369	2034-03-15	Cyprus

Selecting the purpose of visit

- **Step 1: Locate the ‘Purpose of Visit’ Dropdown**
 - In the Conditions window, scroll down to the “Purpose of Visit” section.
 - Click on the dropdown menu labeled “Please Select” to view the available options.
- **Step 2: Choose the Appropriate Purpose**
 - From the list, select the most relevant reason for the applicant’s visit: • Business – If the applicant is traveling for work-related activities, business meetings, or conferences. • Holiday – If the applicant is visiting for tourism or leisure purposes.
- **Step 3: Confirm and Submit**
 - Once the correct purpose is selected, review all details for accuracy.
 - Click “Submit” to finalize the selection.

The screenshot displays the VAS version 2.1.0.10 Production interface. The main window is titled 'WELCOME: Kelsey Snell'. The left sidebar shows the 'TRVR ADJUDICATION INBOX' with a 'HIDE PANEL' button and a list of applications. The central panel shows the 'Application Form' with various fields. A red arrow points to the 'Purpose of Visit' dropdown menu, which is currently set to '<Please Select>'. The dropdown menu is open, showing options: '<Please Select>', 'Business', and 'Holiday'. Below the dropdown, there is a 'Standard Conditions' section with a list of conditions: 'To continue visit', 'Not allowed to change status within South Africa', and 'Subject to Reg. 3(7)'. At the bottom of the form, there is a 'Comments' field with a character count (Maximum Characters: 60, Remaining Characters: 60) and a 'Submit' button.

Application Details

Verify Required Documents

Conditions

Application Form

Permit Valid From

Permit Valid From Date: 27 February 2025

Expiry Date

Period: Calendar Period Value: 27 May 2025

Conditions

Available Conditions:

Purpose of Visit: <Please Select>

Condition: <Please Select>

Business

Holiday

Standard Conditions

To continue visit

Not allowed to change status within South Africa

Subject to Reg. 3(7)

Comments:

Maximum Characters: 60 Remaining Characters: 60

Submit

TrackingNo: TRR4489594

First Name: [Redacted]

Passport Number: L00298369

Passport Expiry Date: 2034-03-15

Passport Country Of Iss: Cyprus

Country Stamp

Airport

Visiting Purposes

Denis APPROVE Save

Submitting the finalized visa decision

- **Step 1: Click ‘Submit’**
 - Once everything is verified, click the “Submit” button to finalize the visa decision.
 - The system will process the application and update its status accordingly.
- **Step 2: Confirm Submission**
 - If a confirmation pop-up appears, click “Yes” to confirm.
 - The visa application will now be recorded as approved and moved forward in the system.

VAS version : 2.1.0.10 Production

WELCOME: Kelsey Snell

Adjudication Reports Progress Logout

TRVR ADJUDICATION INBOX

HIDE PANEL

New Application (3)

- TRVR (3)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(1) (1)
 - TRR4489594 (2025-02-27)
 - Visitor's Visa Section 11(6) (1)
 - Treaty Visa Section 14 (1)

Application Details Verify Required Documents

+ HIDE These details

Applicant Electronic Details

Active Applicant Details TRVR Applicant Details

TrackingNo	First Name
TRR4489594	SONIA

Recommendation

☐ Mark Application For Comments

Application Form

THEREOF:

Type of Visa

Issued At:

Date of issue

Date of expiry

A visa is required

Purpose of visit

(state reason)

Conditions Application Form

Permit Valid From

Permit Valid From Date: 27 February 2025

Expiry Date

Period : Calendar Period Value: 27 May 2025

Conditions

Available Conditions :

Purpose of visit: Holiday

Conditon	Enter Value
Purpose of visit:	Holiday

Standard Conditions

To continue visit

Not allowed to change status within South Africa

Subject to Reg. 3(7)

Comments :

Maximum Characters : 60 Remaining Characters : 60

Submit

Passport Number

Passport Expiry Date

Passport Country Of Iss

L00298369

2034-03-15

Cyprus

Country Stamp

irport

ing Purposes

Denis APPROVE

Save

Comments :

Click here to save comments

Type here to search

11:14 2025/02/27

Confirming that the visa application has been adjudicated successfully

- **Step 1: Confirm Submission**

- After clicking “Submit”, a confirmation pop-up window appears stating: • “Saved successfully.”
- This confirms that the visa application details have been processed and stored in the system.

- **Step 2: Click ‘OK’ to Finalize**

- Click the “OK” button to close the confirmation message.

- **Step 3: Verify the Application Status**

- You may see the application: • Disappear from the pending inbox (if fully processed). • Move to a completed applications list.

- **Step 4: Proceed to the Next Application or Logout**

- If more applications need adjudication, return to the Adjudication Inbox.
- If finished, log out of the system by clicking “Logout” in the top menu.

The screenshot displays the VAS (Visa Application System) interface. The main window is titled "VAS version : 2.1.0.10 Production" and "WELCOME: Kelsey Snell". The top navigation bar includes "Adjudication", "Reports", "Progress", and "Logout". The left sidebar shows the "TRVR ADJUDICATION INBOX" with a "HIDE PANEL" button and a list of applications. The main content area shows the "Application Form" for a specific application (TrackingNo: TRR4489594). The form includes fields for "Permit Valid From", "Permit Valid From Date", "Expiry Date", "Period", "Period Value", "Conditions", "Purpose of visit", and "Standard Conditions". A confirmation pop-up window is overlaid on the form, displaying the message "Saved successfully." and an "OK" button. A red arrow points to the "OK" button. The bottom of the screen shows the Windows taskbar with the search bar and various application icons.

TrackingNo	First Name
TRR4489594	CONIA

Passport Number	Passport Expiry Date	Passport Country Of Iss
L00298369	2034-03-15	Cyprus

Condition	Enter Value
Purpose of visit:	Holiday

Standard Conditions
Not allowed to change status within Subject to Reg. 3(7)

Comments :
Maximum Characters : 60 Remaining Characters : 60

Submit